

The Myth of the Brand Name

Not too long ago, I got a nasty sinus infection and had to get a prescription. When I dropped the doctor's note off at my pharmacy, the lady at the counter asked me if I wanted the brand-name drug or the generic option. I asked her what the difference was, and she said, "About fifty dollars. The medicine is the same; you'd just be paying extra for the brand name." You see, the medicine in the bottle works just as hard no matter what brand is on the label. That made my decision a whole lot easier. As we take a quick look at education, it strikes me that university choice works in much the same way. The name on the diploma can make the degree a lot more expensive, but that doesn't mean it's more effective.